



» WOMEN'S PREMIER LEAGUE ANALYSIS

PROMISE TO PERFORMANCE: THE MAKING OF A WPL STAR

As young talents light up the tournament, a deeper ecosystem of camps, tours and coaching quietly **fuels their rise.**

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The Women's Premier League (WPL) has a way of launching careers, sometimes in the space of a single over. As has been the case every season, several young talents stood out this year, but two in particular caught the eye: Anushka Sharma of Gujarat Giants and Nandini Sharma of Delhi Capitals.

Anushka announced herself through quickfire cameos brimming with confidence. She rarely stayed long enough to pile up big scores, but her impact was immediate. In just her first WPL match, the 22-year-old struck a 30-ball 44 against UP Warriorz, piercing gaps in the field with her 360-degree batting skills.

Nandini, a young pacer, picked up wickets across phases, proving especially lethal at the death with her back-of-the-hand slower ball. One over of hers stood out — four wickets, including a hat-trick, against Gujarat Giants — making her only the second Indian after Asha Sobhana to take a five-fer in the WPL. She finished the season with 17 wickets, the joint-most in the tournament, and claimed the Emerging Player of the Season award.

The season reinforced a familiar truth: when opportunity meets preparation, players can make an immediate mark. Their rise may seem abrupt, that of an unknown name suddenly in the